treated 2.6 million patients, with 200,000 coming from states like Tamil Nadu, Meghalaya, and Kashmir. In the past four years, the state government has appointed 4,496 new doctors and promoted 5,649 doctors. Additionally, the recruitment process for 172 dentists is in its final stages. Hiring for over 20,000 paramedical positions is also underway. The Raj Health portal has been introduced to ensure transparency in doctor and paramedical staff transfers, postings, and related administrative tasks. Through this portal, 1,763 new medical officers were recently appointed. Nursing colleges are now being established in every district of Rajasthan. From having only 10 nursing colleges in the government sector in 2018, the state has witnessed a significant increase with the inauguration of 26 new nursing colleges in the last four years, providing an additional 1,560 nursing seats.

For the year 2023-24, plans are underway to open four new nursing colleges in Masuda (Ajmer district), Nimbahera and Rawatbhatta (Chittorgarh district), and Nawan (Nagaur district). This expansion will raise the total nursing seats to 2,630 in government institutions. Furthermore, Public Health Colleges are being established in each divisional headquarters. In Jaipur, during the 2021-22 academic session, a Master's in Public Health course commenced at the RUHS-run college, offering 25 seats.

EXPANDING MEDICAL EDUCATION IN RAJASTHAN

NEW COLLEGES AND INCREASED SEATS

New medical colleges are set to open in various districts of Rajasthan including Alwar, Baran, Bundi, Banswara, Chittorgarh, Jaisalmer, Karauli, Nagaur, Sirohi, Sri Ganganagar, Dausa, Hanumangarh, and Tonk. Moreover, starting from the 2022-23 academic session, colleges in Sri Ganganagar, Dholpur, Chittorgarh, and Sirohi have introduced 100 MBBS seats each. Plans are in motion to open medical colleges in Alwar, Bundi, Dausa, and Hanumangarh from the 2023-24 session. Except for Dausa, the Government of India has provided Letters of Intent for 100 MBBS seats at these four locations. The remaining colleges are expected to commence operations in the upcoming fiscal year.

Government medical colleges have not been approved in three districts of the state namely Pratapgarh, Jalore and Rajsamand. In these districts, the state government will open medical colleges on its own cost. A total of 15 new medical colleges, accommodating 3,674 beds and costing over Rs 1,224 crore, are in the pipeline. Lands for these colleges have already been allocated. At present, government medical colleges offer 1,690 PG seats and 153 super specialty seats. During the current administration, these numbers have increased by 558 PG seats (from 1,132 to 1,690) and 37 super specialty seats (from 116 to 153). MBBS seats have also witnessed growth in various medical colleges, with increments of 650 in 2019-20, 230 in 2020-21, 100 in 2021-22, and 400 in 2022-23.

The SMS Hospital is now venturing into medical tourism, attracting patients from other states who even seek surgeries for height enhancement. The Skin Bank, a specialized Super Specialty Centre, has been inaugurated at SMS Hospital, a unique establishment in northern India

RAJASTHAN LEADS THE WAY IN ROBOTIC SURGERY ADVANCEMENTS

SMS Hospital becomes the pioneer government facility in North India to perform robotic surgeries.

The introduction of robotic surgery at Jaipur's Sawai Man Singh Hospital marked a novel initiative, set to expand to Jodhpur after Jaipur. This advancement holds promise for revolutionizing patient care through robotic surgery, which is globally recognized as a path to treating severe conditions. SMS Hospital's name stands out on the international stage, aligning with the worldwide trend of leveraging advanced technologies and establishing new medical institutions to address rare and previously incurable ailments. Notably, SMS Hospital's doctors achieved a remarkable feat by performing the country's first-ever robotic technique surgery in a government hospital. This achievement holds significance not only in Rajasthan but throughout northern India, as it stands as the pioneer procedure in any government medical college. The head of the hospital's urology department revealed that the hospital invested Rs 25 crore in acquiring the robotic system, leading to groundbreaking surgeries, like robotic nephrectomies, which take

RAJASTHAN'S IMPRESSIVE HEALTHCARE INFRASTRUCTURE

LEADS THE NATION IN HOSPITAL BED AVAILABILITY

Rajasthan leads the nation with the highest number of hospital beds per 100,000 people.

Within medical institutions in Rajasthan, an additional 6,705 beds have been introduced. The budget for 2023-24 outlines plans to add 380 more beds. In terms of hospital bed availability per 100,000 people, Rajasthan stands ahead of Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Gujarat, Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Punjab, and other states. Government hospitals in Rajasthan offer approximately 151 beds per 100,000 population, compared to 32 in Uttar Pradesh, 61 in Madhya Pradesh, 65 in Gujarat, 21 in Bihar, and 118 in Kerala. Rajasthan has surpassed the IPHS norms set by the Government of India with the establishment of sub-centres, PHCs, and district hospitals. Presently, Rajasthan boasts about 12 CHCs, sub-centres, and satellite hospitals for every 1 million people. This number increases to around 20 when accounting for private hospitals.

A total of 15 new medical colleges, accommodating 3,674 beds and costing over Rs 1,224 crore, are in the pipeline. Lands for these colleges have already been allocated.